

Word family: **big / bigger / biggest / bigness**

Base word: big

Comparative: bigger

Superlative: biggest

Related form: bigness

Useful constructions/extensions: big speech, big decision, big problem, big difference, big deal, big name, big success, big business, big on, think big, make it big, too big for your boots/britches, big-hearted

Part of speech: mainly adjective (形容詞) / informal noun-like expressions (部分口語固定用法)

Your passage contains:

> “She is the kind of person who shows love through small actions rather than **big speeches**.”

Here, **big** means:

grand, dramatic, elaborate, or highly noticeable in scale or style.

It does **not** mean that the speeches are physically large.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **big speeches**

big describes speeches that are:

* grand;

* dramatic;

* elaborate;

* emotionally expressive;

* highly noticeable.

The contrast is:

> **small actions**

> quietly doing caring things

versus:

> **big speeches**

> making grand verbal declarations

****Meaning:**** Large or grand in scale, style, effect, or emotional display.

****繁體中文：**** ****規模、氣勢或表達方式很大、很隆重 / 很誇張的；這裡指不是靠長篇、隆重或高調的說話來表達愛****

****中文翻譯：****

> “She shows love through small actions rather than big speeches.”

「她不是靠****大篇幅 / 隆重高調的說話****，而是透過細微行動來表達愛。」

So:

****big speeches = 隆重、誇張、很有氣勢的說話 / 長篇表白****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****big = large in physical size (大的) — 體積 / 尺寸大的****

This is the basic literal meaning.

****Meaning:**** Large in size, dimensions, or physical extent.

Practice 1

> “They live in a ****big house****.”

「他們住在一間****大房子****裡。」

Practice 2

> “That is a very ****big table****.”

「那是一張很****大的桌子****。」

****big = 物體在整體尺寸、體積或佔用空間上較大****

2. ****big person/animal/object (體型大的) — 體型大；大型的****

Practice 3

> “He is a **big man**.”

「他是一個**身形高大的人**。」

Practice 4

> “It’s a **big dog**.”

「那是一隻**大型狗**。」

big = 人、動物或物件的整體體型 / 體積較大

3. **big** = large in amount/number (大量的) — 很多 ; 大量

A major quantitative sense.

Practice 5

> “They made a **big profit**.”

「他們賺了**一大筆利潤**。」

Practice 6

> “There was a **big increase** in demand.”

「需求出現了**大幅增加**。」

big = 數量、幅度或總量相當大

4. **big** difference/change/increase (很大的差異 / 改變 / 增長) — 大幅 ; 明顯

Practice 7

> “There is a **big difference** between the two versions.”

「兩個版本之間有**很大的差別**。」

Practice 8

> “The new system made a **big change**.”

「新系統帶來了**很大的改變**。」

****big + abstract noun = 某種程度、幅度或影響很大****

5. ****big = important / significant (重要的) — 重要的 ; 重大的****

A major figurative sense.

Practice 9

> “That was a ****big decision****.”

「那是一個****重大決定****。」

Practice 10

> “The presentation was a ****big moment**** for her.”

「那次簡報對她來說是一個****重要時刻****。」

****big = 對結果、人生、計劃或情況有重大影響 / 意義****

6. ****big decision/question/issue (重大決定 / 問題) — 重大的 ; 重要的****

Practice 11

> “We need to discuss the ****big question****.”

「我們需要討論那個****重大問題****。」

Practice 12

> “This is a ****big issue**** for the team.”

「這對團隊來說是一個****重大問題****。」

****big = 重要性高、會帶來明顯後果的****

7. ****big = serious / severe (嚴重的) — 嚴重的 ; 大的****

Practice 13

> “We have a **big problem**.”

「我們有一個**大問題 / 嚴重問題**。」

Practice 14

> “That mistake could become a **big problem**.”

「那個錯誤可能變成一個**嚴重問題**。」

big problem = 嚴重、影響範圍大或難以處理的問題

8. **big** = grand / elaborate / dramatic (隆重 / 誇張的) — 盛大；高調；大陣仗

This is the exact branch used in your passage.

Practice 15 — Original

> “She shows love through small actions rather than **big speeches**.”

「她透過細微行動而不是**隆重 / 高調的說話**來表達愛。」

Practice 16

> “He made a **big speech** about changing his life.”

「他發表了一番**很隆重 / 很有氣勢的說話**，說要改變人生。」

Practice 17

> “They made a **big announcement**.”

「他們作出了一個**隆重 / 重要的宣布**。」

big = 在表達、場合或行動上顯得隆重、戲劇化、很有聲勢

9. **big event/occasion** (大型 / 重要活動) — 盛大；大型

Practice 18

> “The wedding was a **big event**.”

「婚禮是一場**大型 / 隆重活動**。」

Practice 19

> “They are preparing for a **big occasion**.”

「他們正在準備一個**重要 / 隆重場合**。」

big = 規模大、參與人數多或社會 / 個人意義重大

10. **big** = successful / impressive (成功 / 厲害的) — 很成功 ; 很有成就

A major informal sense.

Practice 20

> “The film was a **big success**.”

「那部電影是一次**巨大成功**。」

Practice 21

> “The product became a **big hit**.”

「這件產品變得**非常受歡迎 / 大受歡迎**。」

big = 在成功、受歡迎或影響力方面程度很高

11. **big success / big hit** (大成功 / 大受歡迎) — 非常成功

Practice 22

> “The event was a **big success**.”

「活動**非常成功**。」

Practice 23

> “Her first video was a **big hit**.”

「她第一段影片**大受歡迎**。」

****big = 強調成功 / 受歡迎程度非常高****

12. ****big = famous / influential (有名 / 有影響力的) — 大牌 ; 重要人物****

Practice 24

> “He is a ****big name**** in the industry.”

「他是業內的****大人物 / 知名人物****。」

Practice 25

> “She became a ****big star****.”

「她成為了一位****大明星****。」

****big = 在某個領域具有高知名度、地位或影響力****

13. ****big name (大人物 / 大品牌) — 知名人物 ; 知名品牌****

Practice 26

> “Several ****big names**** attended the event.”

「幾位****知名人物****出席了活動。」

Practice 27

> “The company is a ****big name**** in technology.”

「這家公司是科技界的****知名品牌 / 大公司****。」

****big name = 在某個領域非常有名、具影響力的人或機構****

14. ****big = major / powerful in business (大型的 / 有勢力的) — 大型 ; 重要****

Practice 28

> “She works for a **big company**.”

「她在一家**大公司**工作。」

Practice 29

> “It is one of the **big banks**.”

「那是其中一家**大型銀行**。」

big + organization = 規模、收入、員工數或影響力較大的機構

15. **big business** (大生意 / 重要產業) — 大型產業；大生意

A useful compound.

Practice 30

> “Online education is now **big business**.”

「網上教育現在已成為**很大的產業 / 大生意**。」

Practice 31

> “Tourism is **big business** in the region.”

「旅遊業是該地區的**重要產業**。」

big business = 涉及大量金錢、規模或商業價值的產業 / 活動

16. **big** = popular / fashionable (流行的) — 很受歡迎的；很紅的

A common informal sense.

Practice 32

> “That style was **big** in the 1990s.”

「那種風格在 1990 年代**非常流行**。」

Practice 33

> “This singer is really ****big**** right now.”

「這位歌手現在****非常紅 / 很受歡迎****。」

****big = 某人 / 某事在某時期非常流行、受歡迎或有影響力****

Informal.

17. ****big in + place/group (在.....很受歡迎 / 重要) — 在.....很紅 / 很有市場****

Practice 34

> “The brand is ****big in Asia****.”

「這個品牌在亞洲****很受歡迎 / 市場很大****。」

Practice 35

> “That sport is big among younger people.”

「那項運動在年輕人之間****很流行****。」

****big in/among = 在某地區 / 群體中特別受歡迎或具有影響力****

18. ****big on something (非常重視 / 喜歡) — 很重視 ; 很喜歡****

A useful informal construction.

Practice 36

> “She is ****big on family traditions****.”

「她非常****重視家庭傳統****。」

Practice 37

> “The company is big on customer service.”

「公司非常****重視客戶服務****。」

****be big on X = 很重視、很喜歡或非常支持某件事****

Informal.

19. **big = older / more grown-up (長大的) — 大一點；長大的**

A common child-oriented use.

Practice 38

> “You’re a **big boy** now.”

「你現在是個**大孩子 / 長大了**。」

Practice 39

> “She wants to be like her **big sister**.”

「她想像她的**姐姐**一樣。」

big = 年紀較大 / 較成熟

This appears especially in family/child language.

20. **big brother / big sister (哥哥 / 姐姐) — 年長的兄姊**

A common family expression.

Practice 40

> “My **big brother** helped me.”

「我**哥哥**幫了我。」

Practice 41

> “Her big sister lives abroad.”

「她**姐姐**住在海外。」

big brother/sister = older brother/sister ; 尤其在非正式 / 兒童語言中表示年長兄姊

Note: **older brother/sister** is the neutral standard form.

21. **big = mature / grown-up (像大人一樣) — 成熟；長大了**

Practice 42

> “She felt very **big** carrying her own bag.”

「她自己拿袋子時，覺得自己**長大了 / 很像大人**。」

Practice 43

> “He wants to do everything the big kids do.”

「他想做那些**大孩子**做的所有事情。」

big = 在兒童語境中表示年紀 / 成熟程度較大

22. **big = intense / strong (強烈的) — 強烈；很大的**

A broad degree sense.

Practice 44

> “She has a **big fear** of heights.”

「她非常**害怕高處 / 有很大的恐懼**。」

Practice 45

> “It was a **big shock**.”

「那是一個**很大的震驚**。」

big = 情緒、反應或影響的程度很強

23. **big emotion/reaction (強烈情緒 / 反應) — 很大的；強烈的**

Practice 46

> “The news caused a **big reaction**.”

「消息引起了**很大反應**。」

Practice 47

> “She had a big emotional response.”

「她有很**強烈的情緒反應**。」

****big = 反應 / 情緒的強度或影響程度高****

24. ****big = ambitious (有野心的 ; 宏大的) — 宏大的 ; 有抱負的****

Practice 48

> “They have ****big plans**** for the future.”

「他們對未來有****宏大的計劃****。」

Practice 49

> “She has ****big ambitions****.”

「她有****很大的抱負****。」

****big = 目標、計劃或抱負規模很大 / 非常進取****

25. ****think big (想得宏大) — 有大志 ; 大膽設想****

A major idiom.

Practice 50

> “If you want to grow the business, ****think big****.”

「如果你想發展業務，就要****放膽去想 / 有大格局****。」

Practice 51

> “She always encourages her students to think big.”

「她總是鼓勵學生****放大目標、敢於有大志****。」

****think big = 以有野心、較宏大和進取的方式設定目標 / 構想****

26. ****make it big (大獲成功) — 成名 ; 大成功****

A common informal idiom.

Practice 52

> “She moved to the city hoping to ****make it big****.”

「她搬到城市，希望可以****闖出名堂 / 大獲成功****。」

Practice 53

> “Very few artists make it big immediately.”

「很少藝術家能立即****成名 / 取得巨大成功****。」

****make it big = 在事業、娛樂、商業等領域取得很大成功或成名****

Informal.

27. ****big deal = important matter (大事) — 大事 ; 重要的事****

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 54

> “Getting the promotion was a ****big deal**** for her.”

「獲得晉升對她來說是一件****大事****。」

Practice 55

> “This decision is a big deal.”

「這個決定****很重要 / 是件大事****。」

****a big deal = 很重要、值得重視或影響很大的事情****

28. **no big deal (沒甚麼大不了) — 沒甚麼；小事**

A major conversational idiom.

Practice 56

> “I made a small mistake, but it was **no big deal**.”

「我犯了一個小錯，但**沒甚麼大不了**。」

Practice 57

> “Don’t worry—it’s no big deal.”

「別擔心，**沒甚麼大不了的**。」

no big deal = 某件事並不嚴重 / 重要，不值得過度擔心

29. **What’s the big deal? (有甚麼大不了？) — 有甚麼特別 / 嚴重？**

Practice 58

> “It’s only a small delay. **What’s the big deal?**”

「只是小小延誤，**有甚麼大不了？**」

Practice 59

> “Everyone is excited, but I don’t see what the big deal is.”

「大家都很興奮，但我不明白這有甚麼**特別 / 了不起**。」

what’s the big deal? = 質疑某件事為甚麼被看得那麼重要 / 嚴重

30. **big deal = important person (大人物；非正式) — 大人物**

A separate informal sense.

Practice 60

> “He thinks he’s a **big deal**.”

「他覺得自己是個**大人物 / 很了不起**。」

Practice 61

> “She became a big deal in the fashion industry.”

「她成為時裝界的**重要人物**。」

****a big deal = 很有地位、影響力或名氣的人****

Informal.

31. ****big = generous / emotionally expansive in compounds (寬厚的) — 寬宏 ; 有愛心****

Especially in compounds such as ****big-hearted****.

Practice 62

> “She is a ****big-hearted**** person.”

「她是一個**很有愛心 / 心胸寬厚的人**。」

Practice 63

> “That was a big-hearted gesture.”

「那是一個**非常慷慨體貼的舉動**。」

****big-hearted = 慷慨、善良、願意關心 / 幫助別人的****

A useful family extension.

32. ****big-headed (自大的) — 自負的 ; 自以為了不起的****

A common compound with a non-literal meaning.

Practice 64

> “Success made him ****big-headed****.”

「成功令他變得**自大**。」

Practice 65

> “Don’t get big-headed just because people praise you.”

「不要因為別人稱讚你就變得**自以為了不起**。」

****big-headed = 對自己的能力 / 重要性評價過高、自負的****

33. ****too big for your boots/britches (自以為了不起) — 自大；擺架子****

A common idiom, especially British ****boots**** and American ****britches****.

Practice 66

> “He’s getting ****too big for his boots****.”

「他開始變得**太自大 / 自以為很了不起**。」

Practice 67

> “Success made her too big for her britches.”

「成功令她變得**自以為是**。」

****too big for your boots/britches = 因地位 / 成功而變得過度自信、自大或目中無人****

34. ****big mouth (大嘴巴 / 口沒遮攔的人) — 多嘴；守不住秘密****

A common informal compound.

Practice 68

> “Don’t tell him—he has a ****big mouth****.”

「不要告訴他——他**口沒遮攔 / 守不住秘密**。」

Practice 69

> “I shouldn’t have opened my big mouth.”

「我真不應該**多嘴說出來**。」

****big mouth = 愛亂說話、容易把秘密 / 不該說的事情說出去的人；亦可指這種行為****

Informal.

35. ****big shot (大人物) — 有權勢 / 重要人物****

A common informal expression.

Practice 70

> “He is a ****big shot**** in the company.”

「他是公司裡的****大人物 / 重要人物****。」

Practice 71

> “She acts like a big shot.”

「她表現得像個****很有權勢的大人物****。」

****big shot = 有地位、有影響力或權力的人****

Informal; can be admiring or mocking.

36. ****big time (非常成功 / 大規模；非正式) — 大成功；非常****

A rich informal expression.

Practice 72

> “The product succeeded ****big time****.”

「這件產品****大獲成功****。」

Practice 73

> “I messed up big time.”

「我這次****犯了很嚴重的錯****。」

****big time = 程度非常大 / 嚴重；亦可表示取得重大成功****

Informal.

37. ****the big time (頂級成功層次) — 成名 ; 一流舞台****

Practice 74

> “She finally reached ****the big time****.”

「她終於****躋身成功 / 成名的頂級舞台****。」

Practice 75

> “He dreams of making it to the big time.”

「他夢想有一天能****成名 / 進入頂尖層次****。」

****the big time = 高度成功、知名或重要的職業 / 娛樂層次****

38. ****big picture (大局 / 整體) — 全局 ; 整體情況****

A major modern idiom.

Practice 76

> “Don’t focus on one mistake—look at the ****big picture****.”

「不要只看一個錯誤，要看****整體 / 大局****。」

Practice 77

> “She understands the big picture.”

「她明白****整體局勢 / 大方向****。」

****the big picture = 不只看細節，而是整體情況、主要方向和長遠影響****

39. ****big idea (核心大構思 / 宏大想法) — 重要構思 ; 大想法****

Practice 78

> “What’s the **big idea** behind the campaign?”

「這項宣傳背後的**核心大構思**是甚麼？」

Practice 79

> “The project started with one big idea.”

「這個項目由一個**宏大的構思**開始。」

big idea = 重要、宏大或統領整體方向的構思

40. **Big whoop / big deal** sarcastic use (有甚麼了不起；諷刺) — 有甚麼大不了

A conversational register note.

Practice 80

> “You finished five minutes early? **Big deal.**”

「你早五分鐘完成？**有甚麼了不起。**」

Practice 81

> “So he bought a new car. **Big deal.**”

「所以他買了新車。**有甚麼大不了。**」

Here **big deal** is sarcastically used to mean:

> this is **not** impressive or important.

Tone determines meaning.

Important distinction: big vs large

These overlap strongly.

big

is more common and conversational.

****large****

is often more neutral/formal, especially for measurable size/quantity.

> a big house

> a large house

both natural.

But idioms strongly prefer ****big****:

> big decision ✓

> big deal ✓

> big name ✓

> think big ✓

You cannot mechanically replace every ****big**** with ****large****.

Important distinction: ****big vs great****

****big****

can mean:

- * large;
- * important;
- * serious.

****great****

can mean:

- * large/intense;
- * excellent;
- * important.

Compare:

> “a big problem”

= a serious/large problem.

> “a great problem”

can sound unusual if you mean “excellent problem”; context matters.

And:

> “a great person”

= very admirable person.

> “a big person”

usually means physically large, unless context gives status.

Important distinction: **big vs tall**

big

= large overall body/size.

tall

= great vertical height.

A person can be:

> tall but thin

without being especially:

> big.

So:

big person = 整體體型大

tall person = 身高高

Important distinction: **big vs fat**

This matters for people.

****big****

is broader and can refer to:

- * height;
- * build;
- * muscularity;
- * overall size.

****fat****

specifically refers to having a lot of body fat and can sound rude when applied to people.

So ****big**** is often a softer/broader physical description.

Important distinction: ****big vs wide****

****big****

= overall size.

****wide****

= distance from one side to the other.

> a big table

overall large.

> a wide table

large specifically in width.

Important distinction: ****big vs long****

****big****

= overall size/importance.

long

= length or duration.

In your passage:

> **big speeches**

does not simply mean:

> long speeches.

A speech can be short but still **big** in the sense of:

> grand / dramatic / emotionally elaborate.

This is crucial.

Important distinction: **big speech vs long speech**

long speech

= lasts a lot of time / contains many words.

big speech

= grand, important, dramatic, or highly emphatic.

Your passage specifically contrasts:

> **small actions**

with:

> **big speeches**

so the idea is more:

> quiet action vs grand verbal expression

than:

> short vs long.

Important distinction: **big vs important**

important

directly means significant.

big

is more informal and expressive.

> “a big decision”

≈ an important decision with major consequences.

But **big** can carry extra emotional weight.

Important distinction: **big vs serious**

big problem

often means:

> serious problem / difficult problem.

serious problem

more directly describes severity.

Big is more conversational.

Important distinction: **big vs major**

major

= important/substantial, more formal.

big

= everyday equivalent in many contexts.

> big change

> major change

Both natural, but register differs.

Important distinction: **big event vs large event**

large event

focuses strongly on:

> number of people / physical scale.

big event

may mean:

* large-scale;

* important;

* exciting;

* significant.

So **big** is semantically broader.

Important distinction: **big name vs famous person**

famous person

= widely known.

big name

= well-known and influential within a particular field.

Someone can be a:

> big name in finance

without being famous to the general public.

Important distinction: ****big on vs interested in****

****be interested in****

= have interest.

****be big on****

= strongly like/support/value something.

> “She’s big on family.”

is stronger and more informal than:

> “She’s interested in family.”

The latter can even sound academic rather than affectionate.

Important distinction: ****think big vs dream****

****think big****

= deliberately plan/aim on a large ambitious scale.

****dream****

= imagine/desire something, not necessarily plan it.

****Think big**** emphasizes ambitious scale.

Important distinction: ****make it big vs succeed****

****succeed****

= achieve desired result.

****make it big****

= achieve major success, fame, or wealth.

So:

> make it big

is much stronger and more informal.

Important distinction: ****big deal positive vs sarcastic****

Literal/positive:

> “This is a big deal.”

= 這件事很重要。

Sarcastic:

> “Big deal.”

= 有甚麼了不起。

Tone and sentence structure matter.

Important distinction: ****big brother literal vs Big Brother****

Capitalization matters.

****big brother****

= 哥哥

****Big Brother****

can refer to the authoritarian surveillance figure/concept associated with Orwell's *1984*, and more broadly to intrusive institutional surveillance.

Because capitalization changes the lexical identity, this should be treated as a separate proper-name/cultural extension rather than an ordinary sense of ****big****.

Important distinction: ****big-hearted vs big-headed****

These are almost opposites in evaluation.

****big-hearted****

= generous and kind.

****big-headed****

= conceited/self-important.

Same ****big-**** form, completely different compound meanings.

Important distinction: ****big picture vs detail****

****big picture****

= overall situation.

****detail****

= small individual part.

This contrast is very useful in business and academic contexts.

Family-extension sweep

The practical ****big**** family is rich in physical size, importance, intensity, success, popularity, age, and idiomatic compounds:

- * ****big — physical size**** = 大的
- * ****big person/animal**** = 體型大的
- * ****big — amount**** = 大量 / 幅度大
- * ****big difference/change**** = 很大的差別 / 改變
- * ****big — important**** = 重要的
- * ****big decision/issue**** = 重大決定 / 問題
- * ****big problem**** = 嚴重問題
- * ****big — grand/dramatic**** = 隆重 / 高調
- * ****big speech**** = 隆重、戲劇化的說話
- * ****big event/occasion**** = 大型 / 重要活動
- * ****big success**** = 巨大成功
- * ****big hit**** = 大受歡迎
- * ****big name**** = 知名人物 / 品牌
- * ****big company**** = 大型公司

- * **big business** = 大型 / 重要產業
- * **big — popular** = 很紅 / 很流行
- * **big in/among** = 在某地 / 群體很受歡迎
- * **big on** = 很重視 / 喜歡
- * **big brother/sister** = 哥哥 / 姐姐 (非正式)
- * **big — intense** = 強烈 / 程度大
- * **big plans/ambitions** = 宏大計劃 / 抱負
- * **think big** = 放膽設想 / 有大志
- * **make it big** = 成名 / 大獲成功
- * **big deal** = 大事 / 重要人物
- * **no big deal** = 沒甚麼大不了
- * **what's the big deal?** = 有甚麼大不了 ?
- * **big-hearted** = 慷慨善良
- * **big-headed** = 自大
- * **too big for your boots/britches** = 自以為了不起
- * **big mouth** = 多嘴 / 守不住秘密的人
- * **big shot** = 大人物
- * **big time** = 程度很大 / 大成功
- * **the big time** = 成名 / 頂級成功層次
- * **big picture** = 大局 / 整體情況
- * **big idea** = 核心大構思
- * **bigness** = 大小 / 巨大程度 (較少單獨使用)

The main semantic branches are:

> **large physical size**

> **large amount/degree**

> **importance/significance**

> **grandness/dramatic scale**

> **success/fame/influence**

> **popularity**

> **age/maturity in informal family language**

plus many highly useful compounds and idioms.

Master comparison

| Form / sense | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |

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big — physical size 整體尺寸、體積或佔用空間較大的	
big — amount/number 數量、幅度或總量相當大的	
big difference/change 差異、改變或增幅的程度很明顯 / 很大	
big — important 對結果、人生、計劃或情況有重大影響 / 意義的	
big problem 嚴重、影響範圍大或難以處理的問題	
big — grand/dramatic 表達、場合或行動顯得隆重、戲劇化或很有聲勢	
big speech 隆重、高調、戲劇化或很有氣勢的說話 / 演說	
big event/occasion 規模很大或具有重大個人 / 社會意義的活動	
big success/hit 成功或受歡迎程度非常高	
big name 在某領域具有高知名度、地位或影響力的人 / 機構	
big company/business 規模、收入或影響力較大的公司 / 商業活動	
big — popular 在某時期 / 群體中非常流行、受歡迎或有影響力	
be big on 很重視、很喜歡或強烈支持某件事	
big brother/sister 非正式表示年紀較大的哥哥 / 姐姐	
big — intense 情緒、反應、衝擊或程度非常強	
big plans/ambitions 規模宏大、非常進取的計劃 / 抱負	
think big 以較宏大、有野心的方式設定目標 / 構想	
make it big 在事業、娛樂等領域取得重大成功 / 成名	
big deal — matter 很重要、值得重視或影響很大的事情	
big deal — person 很有地位、影響力或名氣的人	
no big deal 並不嚴重 / 重要，沒有甚麼大不了	
big-hearted 慷慨、善良、心胸寬厚的	
big-headed 對自己評價過高、自負的	
big mouth 愛亂說話、容易洩露秘密的人 / 行為	
big shot 有權勢、地位或影響力的大人物	
big time 程度非常大 / 嚴重；或取得重大成功	
big picture 整體情況、主要方向和長遠影響	
big idea 重要、宏大或統領整體方向的核心構思	

For your original passage

> “She is the kind of person who shows love through small actions rather than ****big speeches****.”

The exact meaning is:

****big = grand, dramatic, elaborate, or highly noticeable in scale/style****

Therefore:

> ****big speeches****

= ****「隆重、高調、很有氣勢的說話 / 長篇表白」****

The contrast is especially important:

> **small actions**

> = quiet, ordinary acts of care

versus:

> **big speeches**

> = grand verbal declarations of love

So **big** here is **not** mainly about physical size.

It is also not exactly the same as:

> **long speeches**

because a speech can be long without being grand, and can be short but still dramatic and “big” in tone.

The phrase tells us something about your grandmother’s personality:

> she does not make grand declarations

but instead:

> makes tea

> cuts fruit

> listens

> helps

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **a big house**

> = 大房子

> **a big difference**

> = 很大的差別

> **a big decision**

> = 重大決定

> **a big problem**

> = 嚴重問題

> **a big speech**

> = 隆重 / 高調的說話

> ****a big event****
> = 大型 / 重要活動

> ****a big success****
> = 巨大成功

> ****a big name****
> = 知名人物 / 品牌

> ****big business****
> = 大型 / 重要產業

> ****be big on family****
> = 很重視家庭

> ****think big****
> = 放膽設想 / 有大志

> ****make it big****
> = 大獲成功 / 成名

> ****a big deal****
> = 大事

> ****no big deal****
> = 沒甚麼大不了

> ****big-hearted****
> = 慷慨善良

> ****big-headed****
> = 自大

> ****the big picture****
> = 大局 / 整體

So ****big**** is much richer than simply:

> ****big = 大的****

and in your original sentence it specifically means:

***“grand, elaborate, or emotionally dramatic in expression, contrasted with small quiet acts of care.”**